

City Council Meeting August 4th 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=mfFz-0QuloY
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Muncie Common Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: August 4, 2025

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearing or committee work session was held prior to the call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding Officer President Mason called the August 4, 2025 meeting of the Muncie Common Council to order at [00:00:32](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Members Present:** Council members Dale Basham, William McIntyre, Roseli (or Selby), Jeff Green, Powell, Garrett, Gilliam, Dishman, and President Mason. (Roll call confirmed all 9 members present at [00:13:42](#)).
 - **Members Absent:** None.
 - **Presiding Officer:** President Mason.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:**

- The Pledge of Allegiance was led by President Mason (00:00:36).
 - A moment of silence and reflection was observed (00:00:58).
 - The invocation was delivered by Minister Lydia Randolph of the Church of the Living God (00:02:02), preceded by a special prayer request from Councilman Dale Basham for Council members and school personnel starting the new school year (00:01:31).
 - Councilman Green recognized high school marching bands across East Central Indiana for their performances at the Indiana State Fair track show on August 1st (00:03:17), specifically highlighting Daleville, Yorktown, and Muncie Central.
 - Councilman Roseli presented the "Citizen of the Month" award for August 2025 to Mr. Jeremy Coons for his selflessness, civic pride, and volunteer cleanup efforts along the west stretch of the White River (00:06:47).
 - **Approval of Minutes:**
 - The minutes of the July meeting were moved for approval by Mr. Green, seconded by Councilman Powell (00:14:03). Following confusion over the voting method, a voice vote was initiated (00:14:29).
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:18:21 Ordinance 22-25: Ordinance Amending Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance (2700 Block North Benton Road)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Presented by legal representation for Mr. Dhy.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The ordinance proposes rezoning a property located at the 2700 block of North Benton Road from an R1 (single-family residential) zone to an R5 (multi-family residential) zone to allow for a multi-family structure. The Plan Commission gave a favorable recommendation of 9-0.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote (Passed 9-0 at 00:19:56).
- **00:19:59 Ordinance 23-25: Ordinance Amending Comprehensive Zoning Ordinance (2611 & 2619 West Ethel Avenue, Vacated Alley, and 700 Block Manning Avenue)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** David Kens, attorney representing Bob Huddleston.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeks to rezone properties from R5 (resident zone) to BV (variety business zone) to match adjacent commercial properties and combine parcels into a single parcel for commercial purposes associated with Huddleston Plaza. Received a 9-0 favorable recommendation from the Plan Commission.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Attorney David Kens spoke in favor of the item (00:21:22).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote (Passed 9-0 at 00:22:15).
- **00:22:21 Ordinance 24-25: Zoning Text Amendment for R-1, R-2, R-3, and R-4 Residential Zones**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Kylen Swackmer, Director of the Plan Commission.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The ordinance amends development standards in R-1, R-2, and R-3 residential zones (adjusting lot widths to 40 feet, lot areas to 4,800 sq. ft., front setbacks to 20 feet, side setbacks to 5 feet, corner lot side setbacks, rear setbacks to 15 feet, and minimum floor area to 600 sq. ft., while removing lot coverage requirements) and addresses accessory dwelling uses as a permitted use in R-4 zones. Proponents stated it modernizes code from 1973, targets vacant/underutilized land, and increases housing opportunities. Opposition and council concerns focused on whether this truly generates affordable housing or simply benefits developers, potential rent inflation, and impact on working-class residents.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Tiffany Ford (00:32:23) questioned whether smaller lots and homes would genuinely assist low-income residents or enrich developers, expressing concerns over skyrocketing rental costs and poor landlord maintenance.
 - Cameron Grubs (01:00:44 / general comments) noted concerns.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Adopted by roll call vote (Passed 8-1, with Councilman Macintosh voting "no" at 00:41:22).
 - **00:41:41 Ordinance 25-25: Emergency Medical Service Fees and Collections**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Chief Burford and City Attorney Dan Gibson.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Seeks to amend EMS billing fees and collection provisions in response to State House Bill 1385 (effective January 1, 2025). Chief Burford explained that the adjustments capture out-of-network private insurance at allowable state rates (up to 400% of CMS rates), noting it affects roughly 2% of total call volume and brings Muncie's rates in line with Delaware County's rates from December 2024. Council members debated the financial strain on the underinsured middle class, high deductibles, and the lack of a pre-established hardship protocol. A motion to table the ordinance failed 4-5 (00:19:04). A subsequent vote on the original ordinance failed.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - Cameron Grubs (01:04:36) spoke against the sharp percentage increases and lack of transparency regarding public impact.
 - Wayne Scafe (01:04:38) questioned the purpose of the hike and the mechanics of the hardship clause.
 - Jason Chapman (01:08:48), President of Local 348, spoke in favor, emphasizing that current rates are based on a 2014 county ordinance, equipment costs have soared (e.g., cots and ambulances), and the policy targets out-of-network big insurance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Failed by roll call vote (01:19:48).
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:20:29 Cameron Grubs:** Requested that future council agendas explicitly list upcoming board vacancies to allow citizen participation, advocated for stricter advance documentation deadlines (two weeks prior), and announced upcoming local events (First Thursday, Ball State \$2 Village tour, Mary's Miles 5K).
 - **01:30:02 Tiffany Ford:** Spoke passionately about the severe shortage of homeless shelters in Muncie, criticizing the sale of the former Justice Department building for luxury condos and suggesting empty spaces like Garfield Elementary School be converted into a multi-resource homeless shelter, clinic, and kitchen.
 - **01:27:28 Courtney Marsh:** Announced the upcoming annual Mark Kenman Family Fun Night in the Southside neighborhood on Tuesday, August 26, starting at 6:00 PM, featuring food, games, and the park splash pad.
 - **01:30:58 Janette Presley:** Highlighted a successful laundry drive partnership with the Muncie Folks Collective and Thomas Park/Avondale Neighborhood Association to help school children with clean clothes, and raised concerns regarding the lack of running water and basic hygiene/shower access for neighborhood children.
 - **01:36:43 Marian Hammond:** A south-side resident, construction worker, and volunteer firefighter/first responder voiced support for community unity across all sides of town, discussed the decline of south-side commercial plazas, and praised recent paving on 27th Street.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Councilman McIntosh noted the Land and Traffic Committee met on July 23rd with sanitation, building commissioner Richard Rawlings, and Police Chief Sloan. Councilman Basham noted an upcoming DLGF budget workshop meeting.
 - **Adjournment:** Moved by Councilman Macintosh, seconded by Councilman Gilliam, and officially adjourned by voice vote at **01:40:54**.
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